

UK TRE CMWG Co-Chairs Retreat 2026

Participants briefing pack

Work time: Tuesday 5th May (10:00) – Wednesday 6th May (16:00)

Location: Hawarden Estate (West End & Gardener's House)

Introduction & Purpose

The core objective of this retreat is to define the long-term purpose and sustainability of the UK-TRE Community.

The agenda is spacious to allow deep and honest reflection. We are in this setting to share space, food and care with each other, to support the relationships essential for this complex work. At the end of this retreat the group should feel confident and aligned in our decisions for the next phase of activity.

Accommodation and venues

We are staying over two properties on the Estate: (1) West End (second and third floors of Hawarden Castle); (2) Gardener's House.

West End

- Go to Hawarden Castle ([dropped pin](#))
- The West End is a private apartment situated on the second and third floors of the Castle
- Head down the steps to the front door of the apartment.
- Locate the lock box: around to the right down on the low wall, facing the front door
- Open the lockbox to retrieve the key: **1839**.
- Please lock the house and leave the key in the lock box when you leave.

Gardener's House

- Head to the front door of the house ([dropped pin](#))
- Go into the red brick garage building opposite the front door.
- Locate the lock box on the right hand side wall inside the garage
- Open the lockbox to retrieve the key: **1809**.
- Please lock the house and leave the key in the lock box when you leave.

Other venues

- Glynn Arms ([dropped pin](#))
- Farm Shop ([dropped pin](#))

We also have private use of the woodland ([dropped pin](#)) a 2 minute walk from the Castle

****Please note your assigned property and room below****

Name	Arrival - Departure	Property	Room/Notes
Claire	n/a	West End	
Cass	Mon – Thur	West End	1 st floor
Isha	Mon – Thur	West End	1 st floor
Simon	Mon – Wed	West End	2 nd floor
James	Tue – Thur	West End	2 nd floor
Jim	Mon – Thur	Gardener's House	1 st floor
Tudor	Mon – Thur	Gardener's House	1 st floor
Madalyn	Tue - Wed	Gardener's House	1 st floor

Wifi

- West End
 - Network: WestEnd_HawardenEstateHolidays
 - p/w: thewestend1868
- Gardener's House
 - Network: TGLS Holidays - Gardener's House
 - p/w: WelcomeToTheGoodLife
- Around the estate
 - Hawarden_Estate_Guest (no password)

Agenda

Day 0 (Monday): Arrivals

Time	Activity	Notes
18:00 – 21:00	Arrivals	See accommodation allocations below
20:00 - 22:00	Dinner	Glynn Arms (set menu with selection)

Day 1 (Tuesday): The Vision & Landscape

Time	Activity	Notes
08:30 – 10:00	Breakfast: West End	Hampers delivered to property
10:00 - 10:30	(1.1) Opening & Framing	Understanding our motivations: Why have you dedicated this time to community work?
10:30 - 12:30	(1.2) TRE Vision Pitches	3-minute pitches: What is your vision for TREs in 2031 and 2036?
12:30 – 13:30	Lunch: West End	Sandwiches delivered
13:30 - 15:30	(1.3) Community Needs (WP2)	Priority areas in achieving this vision for our communities. What is controllable by us?
15:30 – 17:00	(1.4) Community Retrospective	Reviewing the last 4 years of UK TRE activity. Are these aligned with our priorities?
18:00 – 20:00	Dinner: West End	Meal delivered

Day 2 (Wednesday): Strategy & Sustainability

Time	Activity	Notes
08:00 – 09:00	Breakfast: Gardener's House	Hampers delivered
09:00 - 10:30	(2.1) North Star Deliverables	What activities should the community undertake going forwards
10:30 - 12:00	(2.2) Sustainability models	Bootstrap, Service, or member contributed.
12:00 - 13:00	Lunch	Farm Shop (£20pp)
13:00 - 15:30	(2.3) Roadmap & Wrap-up	Finalising an intentional "Purpose and activities" statement.
15:30 - 16:00	(2.4) Consensus & Close	Final alignment check and agreement on outputs.
18:30	Dinner	Glynn Arms (a la carte £45pp)

Day 3 (Thursday): Departures

Time	Activity	Notes
08:00 – 10:00	Breakfast: Both properties	Hampers delivered
10:00	Check out	Rooms vacated

Facilitator Guide: Activities

To move from passive discussion to active decision-making to drive consensus.

1.1 Opening and framing (30 min)

Q: Why have you dedicated this time to community work?

- Round room comments,
- Collect themes on post-its. Cluster

1.2 Vision pitches (120 min)

Q: What is your vision for TREs (not explicitly UK TRE) in 2031 (5y) and 2036 (10y)?

- Slides or a few paragraphs spoken.
- Collect themes on post-its. Cluster around the room.
- Agree a vision

1.3 Priority areas for achieving our vision (120 min)

Q: What do we need in order to achieve our vision?

- Dependencies with risks
- Identify what is controllable by us, and what is not
- Collect themes on post-its. Cluster.
- **Agree requirements / criteria for moving forwards**
- How will we know when we have achieved each requirement?

1.4 Community Retrospective (90 min)

Q: History of UKTRE. What activities have UK TRE done in the past? Are they in support of our vision?

- Group memory retrieval => Timeline
- Summary or activity types (e.g. quarterly meetings, annual conference)
- **Develop a decision matrix to decide if they are in support of our vision**
 - Using the criteria developed above, score previous activities
 - [Example decision matrix](#)

2.1 North Star deliverables

Q: Which activities are taken forward? What new activities do we need?

- Use the decision matrix (updating with justification)
- Identify dependencies for activities

2.2 Sustainability models (90 min)

Q: How do we fund the North Star?

- The Premise: Imagine it is the day after DARE funding has officially ended. There is zero balance in the bank. To survive, UK-TRE must launch as a self-sustaining entity immediately.
- **Team A: The "Bootstrap" Model (Lean & Community-Driven)**
 - The Challenge: Build a model that requires near-zero financial overhead.
 - Focus: How do we deliver our North Star through volunteers, open-source contributions, and reciprocal agreements?
 - The Goal: Identify the value/benefit for the community that will lead people do for free because they believe in the vision?
- **Team B: The "Service" Model (Value-Add & Commercial)**
 - The Challenge: Build a model based on membership fees or paid services.
 - Focus: What "premium" value can the community provide that TRE managers or researchers would be willing to pay for? (e.g., certification, specialized training, exclusive data access standards).
 - The Goal: Identify the tangible "ROI" of the community. What is so valuable that it's worth a line item in someone else's budget?
 - Consider open source funding models
- **Pitches**
 - Preparation (60 min): Each team creates a pitch (on a flipchart or single slide) covering:
 - What is our core "product" (the essential value)?
 - How do we keep the lights on?
 - Why would the TRE ecosystem care if we failed?
 - The Pitch (30 min total): Team A pitches to Team B. Team B grills them on sustainability and impact. Vice versa.
- **Synthesis: After both pitches, the whole group discusses: "Which elements from BOTH models are non-negotiable for our future?"**

2.3 Road map and write up (150 min)

- Document our decision making
- Write a purpose and activities statement
- Create a road map which can be published

2.4 Consensus and close (30 min)

- Actions and responsibilities